

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

BEARS STADIUM

Arlington Heights urges state to act

Suburban mayor tells lawmakers not to ‘fumble’ opportunity on property tax legislation, let team cross border into Indiana

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

Arlington Heights officials called Friday for Illinois lawmakers to get moving on a proposed new Chicago Bears stadium in the north-west suburb — even as Indiana lawmakers introduced a bill to draw the team to their state.

Arlington Heights Mayor Jim Tinaglia warned that without legislation to let the Bears negotiate property

taxes for the stadium, the team may move across the border, warning, “We cannot fumble this opportunity.”

In Indiana, lawmakers introduced a bill last month to create a northwest Indiana stadium authority to acquire and finance sports facilities. Indiana previously created a commission to look into attracting professional sports teams to northwest Indiana, but the new proposal would go further to potentially provide money

for the deal.

The measure was assigned Thursday to the Committee on Appropriations.

Indiana Gov. Mike Braun, in his State of the State address Wednesday, said his administration was “working hard” to attract the Bears. “Let’s get it across the finish line,” he said.

In response to the new legislation, the Bears quickly issued a statement: “The legislation presented

by the State of Indiana is a significant milestone in our discussions around a potential stadium development in Chicagoland’s Northwest Indiana region. We appreciate the leadership and responsiveness of Governor Braun and Indiana lawmakers in advancing a framework that allows these conversations to move forward productively.”

Arlington Heights officials called a news conference Friday and issued an open letter to Illinois lawmakers, urging them to

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Mayor Jim Tinaglia speaks at a news conference in Arlington Heights on Thursday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



BEARS HAVE CHANCE TO FREEZE OUT RAMS
Los Angeles tries to adapt to our own frozen tundra and other keys to Sunday’s game. **Chicago Sports**

IT’S A DINNER PARTY AT SOLDIER FIELD
Playoff run a boost for concessions operator, with even more surprises planned for Sunday. **Business**

THE BEST PLACES TO CATCH THE GAME
Restaurants embrace the Bears with drink deals, food specials and watch-party packages. **A+E**



Team captain Travis Woodworth of the Chicago Pride Hockey, center, yells a chant before a game against the Chicago Aces at the American Heartland Ice Arena on Thursday in Lincolnwood. The group has drawn increased interest amid the popularity of HBO Max’s “Heated Rivalry.” **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**

Gateway to inclusion

By Rebecca Johnson | Chicago Tribune

When Zack Dessent lets people know he plays “gay hockey,” the first thing out of their mouths in recent months is a “Heated Rivalry” joke — and he wouldn’t have it any other way.

Dessent is a board member on Chicago Pride Hockey, a recreational hockey nonprofit for LGBTQ+ players and allies. Not only have a considerable number of people expressed interest in joining the group because of the hit show — they’ve received around 60 inquiries in just the past two weeks.

For players, organization officials at Chicago Pride Hockey, ‘Heated Rivalry’ is more than just a show

But Dessent also enjoyed the depiction of gay relationships in a sport he knows firsthand doesn’t always seem to embrace them. The National Hockey League has never had an active player who is openly gay.

“Anytime that you can expand the game out to be more inclusive and to make people feel more included in the community and seen, I think is really important,” the 33-year-old Lakeview resident said. “I think the fact that the show can be that gateway

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DOJ to probe Minn. leaders

Trump backs away from threat to send troops to the state

By Jack Brook,
Alanna Durkin Richer
and Eric Tucker
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Justice Department is investigating whether Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz and Minneapolis Mayor Jacob Frey have impeded federal immigration enforcement through public statements they have made, according to two people familiar with the matter.

The investigation focused on potential violation of a conspiracy statute, the people said.

The people spoke to The Associated Press on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to discuss a pending investigation by name. CBS News first reported the investigation.

In response to reports of the investigation, Walz said in a statement, “Two days ago it was Elissa Slotkin. Last week it was Jerome Powell. Before that, Mark Kelly. Weaponizing the justice system and threatening political opponents is a dangerous, authoritarian tactic.”

Walz’s office said it has not received any notice of an investigation.

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INSIDE



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Watching out for his heroes

Joe Clark, 13, tries to get a peek at players on the blue carpet during the first day of the Cubs Convention at the Sheraton Grand Chicago on Friday. It continues through Sunday. **Coverage in Chicago Sports**

ELECTION 2026 GOVERNOR

At forum, GOP foes lay into Pritzker

Video gaming operator Heidner says he regrets past donations to Foxx, Johnson

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

WASHINGTON, Ill. — In Rick Heidner’s very first campaign commercial, the Barrington Hills businessman dubs himself a “Trump Republican For Governor.”

But in his very first public

forum as a politician, the onetime-embattled video gambling operator did something President Donald Trump would never do: He apologized.

Participating with the three other major Republican candidates for governor running in the March

17 GOP primary, Heidner found himself on the defensive Thursday night when opponent Ted Dabrowski criticized Heidner’s business operation contributing \$2,500 to the campaign of former Cook County State’s Attorney Kim Foxx and \$25,000 to Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson — two progressive Democrats frequently targeted by Republicans.

Heidner, who has contributed hundreds of thousands of dollars to Democrats and Republicans over the years and does a lot of business in Chicago, told the audience in a central Illinois auditorium that he contributed to Johnson’s campaign as a favor to a friend who, in turn, could get Heidner access to the mayor. But as

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BETTING ON HIMSELF: Rick Heidner spent nearly a quarter of a million dollars to get the petition signatures needed to put him on the ballot as a Republican candidate for governor in the March 17 primary, reports show. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

